

Arabic Reading & Writing at Home

الْقِرَاءَةُ وَالْكِتَابَةُ فِي الْبَيْتِ

For a child who knows the letters with tashkeel and is ready to read and write words

One rule a week · 25 minutes a day · 12 weeks

1. Overview and golden rules
 2. The rules of reading, in teaching order
 3. How to teach: reading, writing, dictation
 4. The 12-week plan
 5. Activity bank (35 games)
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- Then: reading pages, writing pages, rules sheet

Arabic Reading & Writing at Home — Guide for the Older Sister

A practical plan for a child (roughly 6–9) who **already knows the Arabic letters with tashkeel** (she can read ب ب ب on their own) but **cannot yet read or write joined words**. It takes her from single letters to reading short, fully-vowelled stories and writing sentences, in **20–30 minutes a day**.

It is written in English for the parent, with every example in fully-vowelled Arabic.

What's in this folder

File	What it's for
01-arabic-reading-rules.md	The rules, in order: how letters join, the 6 letters that don't, long vowels (مد), sukoon, tanween, shadda, ال with sun/moon letters, ة and ى, the hamza shapes. Read this first.
02-how-to-teach-arabic.md	The method: the daily 25-minute rhythm, how to teach a reading page, how to teach writing (forms → joining → dictation), what to do when she's stuck
03-twelve-week-plan.md	Week-by-week plan: one rule a week, with the reading page and writing page for that week
04-activity-bank.md	35 short games organised by skill so you can swap one in when she's bored
05-progress-tracker.md	Tick-off checklists, plus a "what if she's stuck on..." section
printables/reading-pages.pdf	Print: 12 reading pages (one per week) in big vowelled Naskh, each with a "copy these words" section at the bottom
printables/writing-pages.pdf	Print: letter-forms chart, 7 tracing pages (one per letter family), join-the-letters pages, split-the-word pages, ruled dictation paper
printables/rules-sheet.pdf	Print and hang: 2-page cheat sheet of every rule with examples, plus the sun/moon letters
printables/all-in-one.pdf	Everything above in one file

Where she is, and where she's going

She has done the hardest memorisation already: 28 letters and 3 short vowels. What's left is a **short list of rules**, and each one unlocks a lot of words. Teach them **in this order**, one per week, and don't skip ahead:

Stage	Rule	What she can read after it
1	Letters change shape when they join (and 6 letters never join to the left)	كُتِبَ، ذَهَبَ، سَمِعَ — any word with only short vowels
2	Long vowels: ا after fatha, و after damma, ي after kasra	قَالَ، يَقُولُ، فِي، كَبِيرَ
3	Sukoon: the letter has no vowel, glue it to the letter before	مِنْ، يَكْتُبُ، يَتِ، يَوْمَ
4	Tanween: a doubled vowel mark at the end = add "n"	كُنَّا، قَلْبًا، بَيْتَ
5	Shadda: say the letter twice	أُمٌّ، سَيَّارَةٌ، مَعْلَمٌ
6	ال: moon letters say the ل, sun letters skip it and double the next letter	القَمَرُ، الشَّمْسُ

Stage	Rule	What she can read after it
7	ة at the end, ى at the end, and the five shapes of hamza (ء) (أ إ و ئ)	مَدْرَسَةٌ، عَلِيٌّ، سُؤَالٌ
8	Sentences and short stories	Everything with tashkeel

The short version

1. **Print the three PDFs.** Hang the rules sheet. Keep the reading and writing pages in a folder.
2. **Every day, 25 minutes:** 3-minute warm-up (letter forms flash), 10 minutes on this week's reading page, 10 minutes writing (trace → join → copy → 3-word dictation), then you read her an Arabic story for 5 minutes. Weekends off.
3. **One rule a week.** Read the rule from 01-arabic-reading-rules.md, say it in one sentence to her, then let the page do the teaching. Repeat a week whenever the page isn't fluent by Friday. Repeating is normal, not failing.
4. **Every reading row three times:** you read while she follows with her finger; together; she alone. Then she ticks the box.
5. **Writing is copying, then dictation.** Every day she copies 4 words from the reading page and takes a 3-word dictation from yesterday's page.

Golden rules

- **Vowels are not optional.** For at least a year she reads only fully-vowelled text (نص مشكول). Unvowelled text comes after fluency.
- **Tap, then slide.** Finger taps each letter as she says letter+vowel (بَ - تَ), then slides under the whole word (بَتَ). This is the Arabic equivalent of blending.
- **Short vowel = one clap, long vowel = two claps.** Exaggerate the difference. Most reading mistakes at this stage are short/long confusion.
- **Never let her guess from the first letter.** Cover the rest of the word with your thumb and reveal one letter at a time.
- **Right to left, always,** in reading and writing. Put a small sticker on the right edge of her paper as the "start" mark until it is automatic.
- **Dots after the body.** When writing, she finishes the letter or word body, then goes back and adds dots and hamzas, then vowels.
- **Short beats long.** Ten focused minutes on one page beats thirty minutes on three. Stop while it's still going well.
- **Read to her in Arabic every day.** Five minutes of you reading a vowelised story aloud, finger under the words, is half of the learning.

The Rules of Reading Arabic, in Teaching Order

This is the "basic Arabic stuff" in one place: everything a child needs to go from single letters to reading vowelised text. Each rule is stated the way you'd say it to her, followed by what you need to know as the teacher. The printable [printables/rules-sheet.pdf](#) is the one-page version to hang up.

Rule 0 — What she already knows (recap)

The 28 letters, and the three short vowels (الحركات):

Mark	Name	Sound	Example
-	فَتْحَة fatha	short "a" as in <i>cat</i> (or "u" in <i>but</i>)	بَ
-	كَسْرَة kasra	short "i" as in <i>sit</i>	بِ
-	دُمَّة damma	short "u" as in <i>put</i>	بُ

Check she can do this fast with **any** letter, in random order, in one breath: تَ تْ تُ جْ جُ جِ عَ عُ عِ. If a letter is slow, that letter goes on the daily warm-up pile. Everything below assumes this is automatic.

Rule 1 — Letters hold hands (joining) — Week 1-2

Say to her: "In a word, letters hold hands. When a letter holds hands it loses its tail, but keeps its body and its dots."

- Every letter has up to **four shapes**: alone, at the start, in the middle, at the end. بَ · بِ · بُ · بِْ
- The **body** (the part with the dots) stays the same. Only the tail/hook changes. So she is not learning 100 new letters; she is learning to spot the body.
- Teach shapes in **families** that share a body: 1. ب ت ث ن ي (the tooth family; note ن and ي change more at the end: ن ي 3. ا د ذ ر ز و (ن ي 2. ج ح خ 4. (the six that never hold hands to the left, see below) 6. ف ق ك ل م (ع and غ lose their open "mouth" in the middle: ع غ becomes ك in the middle; م becomes هـ 7. ه ة ء لا (هـ has the strangest middle form لا is one shape for ل + ا)

The six that don't hold hands to the left (حروف لا تتصل بما بعدها): ا د ذ ر ز و. They connect to the letter *before* them (on the right) but never to the letter *after* them (on the left). So the word breaks after them and the next letter starts fresh: دَ رَ سَ = دَ + رَ + سَ (three pieces), وَلَدَ = وَلَ + دَ. Teach her the little rhyme: "أ، د، ذ، ر، ز، و — six letters that let go."

How to read a joined word (this is the core skill): 1. Find each letter's body and its vowel. 2. **Tap and say** each letter with its vowel: 3. بَ - تَ - كَ. **Slide** the finger under the whole word and say it fast: كَتَبَ.

Start with 3-letter words with only short vowels (لَعَبَ، جَلَسَ، سَمِعَ، ذَهَبَ، كَتَبَ) and 2-letter words (لَكَ، مَعَ، هِيَ). No madd, no sukoon yet: those are Weeks 3 and 5. Four-letter words with only short vowels are rare, so don't hunt for them; 3-letter words are enough to make joining automatic.

Rule 2 — Long vowels: حُرُوفُ الْمَدِّ — Week 3-4

Say to her: "Three letters can be stretched. ا after a fatha, و after a damma, ي after a kasra. When a letter is stretched, it has no vowel of its own: it just makes the vowel before it long. Clap twice."

Long vowel	Written	Example	Sound
fatha + ا	اَ	قَالَ، نَامَ، بَابَ	"aa"
damma + و	وُ	يَقُولُ، نُورُ	"oo"
kasra + ي	يِ	فِي، كَبِيرٌ، يَبِيعُ	"ee"

- The madd letter carries **no haraka** (no mark, or in some books a tiny sukoon-free space). If ي or و carries a vowel, it's a consonant (يَدٌ، وَلَدٌ), not a madd.
- Short vs long is the big battle.** Do minimal pairs out loud: سَلَامٌ / سَلَمَ، عَالَمٌ / عَلِمَ، جَمَالٌ / جَمَلَ. One clap vs two claps.
- Combination: آ (= أأ): أَدَمَ، قُرْآنٌ with an alif hamza on top is written مَدٌّ.

Rule 3 — Sukoon: السُّكُونُ — Week 5

Say to her: "A little circle on a letter means: no vowel. Don't add a sound. Just glue that letter to the one before it."

- ◌ on a letter: say the letter's sound with no vowel, joined to the previous syllable: مَ + نَ = مِّنْ = "min". يَكْتُبُ = يَكْتُ - ت - ب.
- Reading trick: **the letter before the sukoon carries it.** Tap them as a pair: مَنَ (one tap), - عَ - يَلْ.
- Two special sukoon pairs (the diphthongs):**
 - fatha + يِ = "ay": يَيْتٌ، عَيْنٌ، كَيْفٌ، لَيْلٌ
 - fatha + و = "aw": يَوْمٌ، لَوْنٌ، نَوْمٌ، خَوْفٌ
- The first letter of a word never has sukoon. The last letter of a sentence is usually read with sukoon when you stop (وَقَفَ), even if it has a vowel: قَلَمٌ at the end is read "qalam". Teach this in Week 10 with sentences, not before.

Rule 4 — Tanween: التَّنْوِينُ — Week 6

Say to her: "Two of the same vowel mark at the end of a word means: add an 'n' sound. Only at the end."

Tanween	Written	Sound	Example
tanween fath	َ (with an extra alif)	"an"	كُتِبَ، قُلِبَ، يَتَى
tanween damm	ُ	"un"	كُتِبُ، قُلِبُ، يَتَى
tanween kasr	ِ	"in"	كُتِبِي، قُلِبِي، يَتَى

- Tanween fath is written with an **alif that is silent** (كُتِبَا): the alif is not a madd, it's just the "seat" of the tanween). Exceptions: no alif after ة (مَدْرَسَةٌ) or after hamza-on-alif (خَطَا) or alif (سَمَاءٌ) is written on the hamza).
- The "n" is heard but no ن is written. This is why dictation gets tricky: "qalamun" has no ن.
- Practise nouns in all three: بَابٌ · بَابًا · بَابٍ.

Rule 5 — Shadda: الشدة — Week 7

Say to her: "The little 'w' on top means: say the letter twice. First time with sukoon, second time with its vowel."

- ّ: the letter is doubled. مَعْلَم = م - عَل - ل - م. رَبَّ = رَب + ب. مَعْلَم = م - عَل - ل - م.
- The shadda's vowel sits **above** it for fatha and damma (بَ، بِ) and, in most children's books, **below the shadda but above the letter** for kasra (بِ). Show her both.
- Shadda + tanween is common at word ends: دَبَّ، حَجَّ، قَطَّ، أَمَّ، جَدَّ.
- Practice with rhythm: clap-clap on the doubled letter: سَيِّدَا رَاة.

Rule 6 — The definite article ال — Week 8

Say to her: "ال at the start means 'the'. With half the letters you say the ل, with the other half the ل disappears and the next letter gets a shadda."

- **Moon letters (الحروف القمرية)** — the ل is pronounced, and it carries a sukoon: ا ب ج ح خ ع غ ف ق ك م. Memory sentence: ه وي القمر، الباب، الكتاب، الولد، البيت، العين، الماء، الهواء (the classic one; each letter in it is a moon letter).
- **Sun letters (الحروف الشمسية)** — the ل is written but silent, and the next letter takes a shadda: ت ث د ذ ر ز س ش ص ض ط ظ ل ن الشمس، النهر، الدرس، السماء، الرجل، الطريق، الصف، الليل، التفاح، الزهرة. Reading cue: **if the ل has no sukoon and the next letter has a shadda, it's a sun letter: skip the ل.**
- Rule of thumb for her: "Look at the ل. Sukoon on it → say it. Nothing on it and a shadda next door → don't say it."
- The alif of ال is a **hamzat wasl**: it's pronounced "a" at the start of speech (الْبَيْت = "al-bayt") but silent when the word before runs into it (فِي الْبَيْت = "fil-bayt"). Introduce this only in Week 10 with sentences.

Rule 7 — Endings and hamza shapes — Week 9

ة (تاء مربوطة)

- Only at the end of a word. It says "t" when you keep going, "h" when you stop. مَدْرَسَةٌ (madrasatun) → stopping: مَدْرَسَة (madrasah).
- Most feminine words end with it: مَعْلَمَةٌ، سَيَّارَةٌ، شَجَرَةٌ، فَاطِمَةٌ.
- Writing rule: it's a ه with two dots. Don't confuse with ه (his/him ending: كِتَابُهُ) which has no dots.

ي (ألف مقصورة)

- Only at the end. Looks like ي without dots. Sounds like a long "aa": عَلِيٌّ، إِلَى، مَتَّى، مُوسَى، عِيسَى، مُسْتَشْفَى.
- Compare: ي with dots at the end is "ee" (فِي، عَلِي) or "y".

The five shapes of hamza (ء)

All are the same sound: the catch in the throat at the start of "apple" said sharply.

Shape	Where	Examples
أ (on alif, above)	start of word with fatha/damma; sometimes middle/end	أَحْمَدُ، أُمُّ، سَأَلَ، قَرَأَ
إ (on alif, below)	start of word with kasra	إِبْرَاهِيمَ، إِلَى، إِنَّ
ؤ (on و)	middle/end near a damma	سُؤَالٌ، مُؤْمِنٌ، لَوْؤُ

Shape	Where	Examples
ئ (on ي-seat)	middle/end near a kasra	بُرْ، سَائِلْ، قَارِيْ
ء (on the line)	end after a long vowel or sukoon	مَاءَ، سَمَاءَ، شَيْءَ، ضَوْءَ

For reading, she just needs to recognise all five as "hamza" and read the vowel on it. The spelling rule (which seat) comes much later.

Other small things she'll meet

- لا : ل + ا (لام ألف). On its own it means "no": لا. Inside words: سَلَامٌ، أَوْلَادٌ، بِلَادٌ. Some fonts draw it as لا and some as لا; both are the same two letters.
- **The silent alif after و** in plural verbs: كَتَبُوا، ذَهَبُوا, read "katabuu". Just say: "this alif is silent."
- **Small alif** (الألف الخنجرية) above a letter in some words: هَذَا، ذَلِكَ، لَكِنَّ، الرَّحْمَنُ — read as a long "aa". Many children's books write هَذَا with the small alif; tell her it's a madd alif.
- **Two-letter words she'll see constantly:** أَنْتَ، أَنَا، يَا، مَا، هَذِهِ، مَنْ، مَآذَا، أَيْنَ، كَيْفَ، مَتَى. هُوَ، هِيَ، هَذَا، هَذِهِ، هِيَ، هَذَا، هَذِهِ، مَنْ، مَآذَا، أَيْنَ، كَيْفَ، مَتَى.

Rule 8 — Reading sentences — Weeks 10-12

- **Stopping (الوقف):** at the end of a sentence, drop the last vowel: ذَهَبَ الْوَلَدُ إِلَى الْمَدْرَسَةِ → read "...al-madrasah". Tanween at the stop: damm/kasr tanween become silent (قَلَمٌ → "qalam"), fath tanween becomes a long "aa" (قَلَمًا → "qalamaa").
- **Hamzat wasl in flow:** ال and words like اِسْمُ، اِنْ، اِنِ lose their initial "a" when the previous word runs into them: فِي الْبَيْتِ = "fil-bayt".
- **Punctuation:** Arabic comma is ،, question mark is ؟, full stop is . as in English.
- **Numbers:** ٩ ٨ ٧ ٦ ٥ ٤ ٣ ٢ ١ ٠ — written left to right even inside Arabic text.

The order, one more time

1. Joining (families + the six non-connectors) → 2. Madd → 3. Sukoon (+ ay/aw) → 4. Tanween → 5. Shadda → 6. ال sun/moon → 7. ة hamza → 8. Sentences.

This is essentially the order of the classical children's primers (نور البيان، القاعدة النورانية). If you have one of those books, this guide's weeks line up with its chapters.

How to Teach Arabic Reading and Writing to a 6-9-Year-Old

Read this once before Week 1. Come back to the last section when something isn't working.

The 25-minute day

Block	Minutes	What	How it feels
1. Warm-up	3	Flash 10 letters in their joined shapes (هـ...); she says the letter. Then 5 letters with random vowels.	A speed game
2. Reading page	10	This week's page from <code>reading-pages.pdf</code> . Every row three times (below).	Reading with Mama
3. Writing	10	Trace (Weeks 1-2) → copy 4 words from the reading page → 3-word dictation from yesterday's page	Quiet desk time
4. Story	5	You read her a vowelised Arabic story, finger under the words. She can join in on words she knows.	Cuddle time

Five days a week. If a day goes badly, do only blocks 1 and 4 and call it done. If she is also doing school homework, put this **before** homework, not after: attention is a morning resource.

Rules that keep it working - One rule per week. The plan introduces exactly one new idea a week. Don't combine, don't rush. If Friday's reading is still slow, repeat the week with the same page. - **Stop early.** End the reading block while she's still winning. - **She ticks the box.** Every row on the page has a tick box. She ticks it herself after reading the row alone. Visible progress matters more at 7 than at 4. - **Praise the mechanism, not the result:** "You spotted the sukoon and glued it. That's exactly it." Not "good girl." - **Mistakes are information.** Don't say "no." Say "look again at the vowel on the ت," and wait.

Reading

How she reads a word (teach this in Week 1, keep it for months)

1. **Right edge first.** Finger goes to the right end of the word.
2. **Tap and say:** each letter with its vowel. بَ - تَ - كَ. (In Arabic classrooms this is called التَّهَجُّة.)
3. **Slide and say:** finger slides under the word, right to left, and she says it in one go: كَتَبَ.
4. If it came out wrong, **don't repeat the word for her.** Go back to step 2 on the letter that went wrong.

When she's fluent on a row, she stops tapping and just slides. Tapping comes back automatically for any new hard word. That's the goal.

How to run a reading page (10 minutes)

Each page has 5-7 rows of words (later, sentences). Every row, three passes:

1. **You read, she follows.** Your finger under the word, normal speed, exaggerated vowels. She watches and listens.
2. **Together.** Both of you, her finger, slightly slower.
3. **Alone.** She reads the row. Tick the box.

Then the bottom section: **she copies 4 words** from the page (writing block). Next day, the same page starts with a 1-minute reread of rows she ticked, then new rows. Most pages take 3-4 days to finish; the 5th day is a "read the whole page to Baba/Grandma" performance.

Say the sounds well

- **Short vowel: one beat. Long vowel: two beats.** Clap it. Over-do it for the first month: "qa-a-la". Short/long confusion is the number one error, and it's an ear problem, not an eye problem.
- **Emphatic letters (ص ض ط ظ ق) are "heavy".** Tell her: "make your mouth big and heavy." Pairs to contrast: كَقْ / ذَظْ, دَاضْ / تَاطْ, سَاصْ / نَائِنْ. The "heavy" letters also darken the vowel: طَيْن vs طِين.
- **Throat pairs:** أَعْ / هَاحْ. Play "which one did I say?" with your hand on her hand so she feels it in your throat.
- **Sukoon = no vowel at all.** Don't let "مِنْ" become "mi-nə". The نْ is glued.

If Arabic is not the language spoken at home

Reading a word she doesn't know is fine: decoding is decoding. But meaning makes it stick, so: - After each row, ask "which word means...?" for 1-2 words. Every word on the printable pages is a real, common word. - Add 5 minutes of Arabic talk a day: name things at dinner, count, give simple commands (اجْلِسِي، افْتَحِي الْبَابَ). - Cartoons in fusha (e.g. the classic dubbed ones) with the vowelised subtitles off, just for the ear.

Writing

The three stages

1. **Forms (Weeks 1-2):** tracing each letter in its 4 positions on ruled lines. [writing-pages.pdf](#) has one page per letter family.
2. **Joining (Weeks 1-4):** "join the letters" (كَتَبَ → كَ + تَ + بَ) and the reverse, "split the word" (كَتَبَ → كَ، تَ، بَ). This is the same skill as reading, from the other side.
3. **Copying then dictation (from Week 2, every day):** copy 4 words from the reading page; next day, 3 of those words from dictation (إِمْلاء). Dictation is where reading rules turn into spelling rules.

The physical rules, in the order you'll need them

- **Right to left.** Sticker on the right edge of the page = start. Move it only when she never needs it.
- **Sit on the line.** Most letters sit on the baseline; some dip below (ج ح خ ع غ ص ض ق ل م ن ي ة) at word end, and ر ز و always). The ruled writing paper in the printables has a baseline and a dip line.
- **Body first, dots after, vowels last.** Write the whole word's bodies in one flow, then go back right-to-left adding dots, hamzas, and finally harakat. This is how adults write and it stops the "one dot missing" errors.
- **Dots are dots.** One dot, two dots side by side, three in a triangle. Not dashes, not circles. Two dots may be written as a short dash in handwriting later, not now.
- **Pencil, ruled paper, big.** Letters about 1 cm tall for the first month. Two-line paper (two lines with a gap) makes ascender letters (ا ل ك ط ظ) easy to size.
- **Tooth family in the middle is the hardest:** ج ت ث ش ذ ز ح all look the same body; only dots differ. Practise words like ثَبَّتْ، نَبَيْتْ، تَيْنْ where teeth are next to each other, and count the teeth: "one, two, three teeth, dots on the second."
- **The six non-connectors:** ا د ذ ر ز و, **lift the pencil** and start the next letter fresh. Say "let go" out loud in Week 1.

How to teach a letter family (one writing session)

1. Show the family's page. Point out what stays (the body) and what changes (the tail).
2. She traces each form once with her finger, saying its position: "at the start, in the middle, at the end."
3. Trace the row in pencil.
4. Write the example words (they are on the page), copying from the model.
5. Done. One family per session; some families take two sessions (ه and ط ظ ع غ).

Dictation, the gentle way

- 3 words, from **yesterday's** reading page, always ones she has copied already.
- Say the word slowly, twice, with clear vowels. She writes. Don't spell it for her.
- Then she checks her own word against the page and fixes it herself with a different colour. Finding your own mistake is the learning.
- Keep a "Words I can spell" list (in 05-progress-tracker.md).

Things that look like problems but aren't

What you see	What it means	What to do
She reads the first letter and guesses the word	She's treating it like memorised sight words	Thumb over the rest of the word, reveal one letter at a time
Reads كَتَبَ as "kataba" one day, "kutub" the next	Ignoring vowels	Back to tap-and-say for a week; she must say each vowel
Says "ka-a-taba" for كَتَبَ (adds length)	Short/long ear confusion	Clap game; minimal pairs (جَمَلٌ/جَمَالٌ)
Can't find ه or هـ in the middle of a word	Those two middle forms don't look like the letter	Extra time on family 5 and 7 pages; "find the ع" hunt in a story
Writes left to right or mirrors letters	Directionality not automatic yet, normal until ~8	Right-edge sticker; you say "start on the right" every time, calmly
Forgets dots, or puts them on the wrong tooth	Writing dots too early, mid-word	Body first, dots after. Count the teeth.
Writes ه for ة or ي for ى at the end	Doesn't yet know the ending rules	Wait for Week 9; until then just correct the dot without comment
Leaves the alif off tanween fath (كَابُ)	Very common; the alif looks silent so she skips it	"Tanween fath rides an alif." Check it in every dictation.
Reads sun-letter words with the ل ("al-shams")	Hasn't automated the ل rule	Highlighter game: she highlights the ل she should NOT say before reading the row
Reads fluently but slowly	That's just fluency arriving	Reread. Same page 3 days = speed. That's not cheating.
Resists the whole thing	Sessions too long, or too many rules at once	Cut to 10 minutes, one page, for a week; games from the activity bank only

The 12-Week Plan

One rule a week. Each week has **one reading page** ([printables/reading-pages.pdf](#) , page number = week number) and its writing work. Repeat any week that isn't fluent by Friday; the plan is a sequence, not a calendar.

Daily: warm-up 3 min → reading page 10 min → writing 10 min → story 5 min. Weekends off.

Codes: RP = reading page, WP = writing page ([printables/writing-pages.pdf](#)), AB # = activity in [04-activity-bank.md](#).

Month 1 — Joining and long vowels

Week	Rule	Reading (RP)	Writing (WP)	Game of the week
1	Letters hold hands. Families 1-3: ب ت ث ن ي: ٠ ج ح خ ٠ ا د ذ ر ز و. The six that let go.	RP 1: 2- and 3-letter words with short vowels only: كَتَبَ، ذَهَبَ، جَلَسَ، لَعِبَ، هُوَ، مَعَ	WP: letter forms chart; tracing pages for families 1-3; "join the letters" page 1	Magnet word-building (AB #1)
2	Families 4-7: س ش ص ض ط ظ ع غ ٠ ف ق ك ل م ه. Middle ع and ه. ٠ ه ة ء لا	RP 2: more short-vowel words: سَمِعَ، عَمِلَ، فَهِمَ، شَرِبَ، صَنَعَ، قَفَزَ، ضَحِكَ، هَرَبَ	WP: tracing pages for families 4-7; "split the word" page; start daily copying (4 words) + dictation (3 words)	Body-and-tail sort (AB #4)
3	Madd with ا and و. Two claps.	RP 3: قَالَ، نَامَ، يَأْتِي، كَانَ، زَارَ، يَقُولُ، يَزُورُ، يَصُومُ، نور	Copy + dictation. Ruled-paper page: write the madd words, circle the madd letter.	Clap the vowel (AB #8)
4	Madd with ي + all three mixed.	RP 4: فِي، كَبِيرٌ، صَغِيرٌ، يَبِيعُ، قَالَ: مِخْتَلِطٌ، سَعِيدٌ، يَقِيلُ... and minimal pairs جمال/جَمَل	Copy + dictation. "Which madd?" sorting page.	Long-or-short cards (AB #9)

Week 4 check-in: she reads RP 1-4 with tapping only on new words. If joining is still slow, repeat Weeks 1-2 with the same pages before going to sukoon.

Month 2 — Sukoon, tanween, shadda, ال

Week	Rule	Reading (RP)	Writing (WP)	Game of the week
5	Sukoon: glue it. Then ay / aw: fatha + و , fatha + ي	RP 5: مِنْ، عَنْ، هَلْ، قَدْ، لَمْ، أَنْتَ، يَكْتُبُ، يَلْعَبُ، يَذْهَبُ، يَتُّ، عَيْنٌ، كَيْفَ، يَوْمٌ، لَوْنٌ، نَوْمٌ	Copy + dictation; "mark the sukoon" page	Glue-it robot (AB #12)
6	Tanween: add an n. Fath rides an alif.	RP 6: كَأَبٌ، كَأَبًا، كَأَبٌ، قَلَمٌ، يَتُّ، بَابٌ in all three	Copy + dictation (watch the alif!). Tanween triplets page.	Three-cup tanween (AB #15)
7	Shadda: say it twice.	RP 7: أُمٌّ، جَدٌّ، رَبٌّ، قَطٌّ، دُبٌّ، سَتٌّ، عَلٌّ، سَلٌّ، كَبْرٌ، مَعْلٌ، سَيَّارَةٌ، تَفَّاحٌ، سَكْرٌ	Copy + dictation. "Double it" page: write the letter twice, then with shadda.	Clap-clap shadda (AB #18)

Week	Rule	Reading (RP)	Writing (WP)	Game of the week
8	ال: moon says ل, sun doubles.	RP 8: moon: الْقَمَرُ، الْيَابِ، الْكِتَابُ، الشمس، النهر، sun: الولد، البيت، الدرس، السماء، الرجل، الطريق، الليل	Copy + dictation. Sun/moon sort page. Hang the sun/moon chart.	Sun & moon sort (AB #21)

Week 8 check-in: open any vowelised children's book. Can she read a full line with 1-2 stumbles? Then move on. If ال is shaky, one more week on RP 8 with the highlighter game.

Month 3 — Endings, sentences, stories

Week	Rule	Reading (RP)	Writing (WP)	Game of the week
9	ة at the end, ى at the end, 5 hamza shapes.	RP 9: مَدْرَسَةٌ، شَجَرَةٌ، مَعْلَبَةٌ، فَاطِمَةُ، عَلَى، إِلَى، مَتَى، مُوسَى، أَحْمَدُ، إِبْرَاهِيمُ، سؤال، بئر، ماء، سماء، شيء	Copy + dictation. "ة or ى or ي?" page. Hamza hunt in a story.	Ending detective (AB #24)
10	Sentences. Stopping at the end (drop the last vowel), ال after a word (في البيت).	RP 10: 8 sentences, 3-5 words each: ذَهَبَ الْوَلَدُ إِلَى الْمَدْرَسَةِ.	Copy 2 sentences a day. Dictation: 1 sentence.	Sentence strips (AB #27)
11	Short stories.	RP 11: two 5-line stories (a cat; a school morning) + 3 questions each	Write 3 sentences answering the questions.	Story theatre (AB #30)
12	Celebration + check-in. No new rules.	RP 12: a 10-line story, read to Baba/Grandma on video; reread favourite pages	She writes 3 sentences about herself; a card for someone in Arabic.	Certificate day (AB #35)

What comes after Week 12

- **Reading:** graded vowelised readers, 10 minutes a day; then Qur'an-style reading practice if that's a goal (the rules above are exactly the ones a Qaida course assumes); gradually text with partial tashkeel (Grade 3-4 school books).
- **Writing:** her own sentences daily (a 3-line diary in Arabic), spelling rules for hamza seats, the difference between ت/ة endings, and cursive speed.
- **Grammar** is not for now. Reading fluency and a big word bank first.

If a week goes badly

- **Resisting:** cut to 10 minutes, one page, games only, for a week. It's usually "too long," not "too hard."
- **A rule isn't sticking:** repeat the week. Or go back one rule; a shaky sukoon is often a shaky madd underneath.
- **She's flying:** don't add rules faster. Add reading: more books, more rows, longer stories. Fluency needs miles, not new rules.

Activity Bank — 35 Short Games

Each takes 3-8 minutes. Swap one in whenever the page feels flat. Numbers match the plan's "Game of the week."

Joining letters and letter forms (Weeks 1-2)

1. **Magnet word-building.** Arabic magnetic letters (or letters written on bottle caps) on a tray. You say كَتَبَ, she builds it right-to-left, then reads it. Then swap one letter: كَتَبَ → كَتَمَ → رَسَمَ.
2. **Find the body.** A page of a vowelised story. "Find every ب, in any position." Highlighter. Count them.
3. **Let go!** Cards for ا د ذ ر ز و in red, all other letters in blue. She builds words; at each red card she claps once ("let go") and starts the next letter apart.
4. **Body-and-tail sort.** Cards showing letters in middle form (ك ب ج ه ح ...). She sorts them into the 7 family piles by body.
5. **Letter dominoes.** Cards with a letter's final form on one side and another's initial form on the other; match to make joined pairs.
6. **Sand tray forms.** Write a letter's 4 forms in a tray of semolina with a finger, saying "alone, start, middle, end."
7. **Which one changed?** Two words that differ by one letter (بَابَ/نَابَ, سَمِعَ/سَمَحَ). She spots and reads both.

Long vowels (Weeks 3-4)

8. **Clap the vowel.** You say a word; she claps once for a short vowel, twice for a long one. Then reverse.
9. **Long-or-short cards.** Pairs: جَمَلٌ/جَمَالٌ, عِلْمٌ/عَالَمٌ, كَتَبَ/كَاتِبٌ, مَلِكٌ/مَالِكٌ. Shuffle, draw, read, say which.
0. **Stretch the elastic.** Hold a rubber band; stretch it while saying the long vowel. Physical = memorable.
1. **Madd hunt.** In a story page, circle every alif/waw/yaa that is a madd (no vowel on it). Trick: some و and ي are consonants.

Sukoon (Week 5)

2. **Glue-it robot.** You say a word letter by letter; at the sukoon she says "glue!" and joins it to the previous letter. مِ - نَ → "min".
3. **Sukoon cards.** Word cards with the sukoon covered by a sticky flag. She reads, lifts the flag, reads again correctly.
4. **ay/aw pairs.** يَوْمٌ/يَوِّمٌ (nonsense), يَتُّ/يَاتُّ (nonsense), عَيْنٌ/عَيْنٌ: which is real, which is silly? Read both.

Tanween (Week 6)

5. **Three-cup tanween.** Three cups labelled ...^٥. Say a word ("kitaabun", "kitaaban", "kitaabin"); she drops a bead in the right cup, then writes the word with the right ending.
6. **Alif police.** Dictate tanween-fath words; she must "arrest" any missing alif with a red circle.
7. **Rhyme the ending.** She names three things in the room with tanween damm: بَابٌ, قَلَمٌ, كُرْسِيٌّ.

Progress Tracker

Tick as she masters each item. "Mastered" = she does it without prompting, three days in a row.

Reading rules

- ☐ Reads any letter with fatha / kasra / damma instantly (Rule 0)
- ☐ Recognises the 7 letter families in all positions
- ☐ Knows the 6 non-connectors (ا د ذ ر ز و) and reads words that "let go" correctly
- ☐ Reads 3-letter short-vowel words without tapping (كَتَبَ)
- ☐ Reads long vowels ا و ي with two beats (قَالَ، يَقُولُ، فِي)
- ☐ Hears the difference جَمَل / جَمَال
- ☐ Reads sukoon correctly, glued (مَنْ، يَكْتُبُ)
- ☐ Reads ay / aw (بَيْت، يَوْم)
- ☐ Reads all three tanween (كِتَابٌ، لَاءٌ)
- ☐ Reads shadda as a doubled letter (مُعَلِّم)
- ☐ Reads ال with moon letters (القَمَر)
- ☐ Reads ال with sun letters, silent (الشَّمْس)
- ☐ Reads ة correctly at a stop and in flow
- ☐ Reads ى as long "aa" (عَلَى)
- ☐ Recognises all 5 hamza shapes
- ☐ Drops the final vowel at the end of a sentence
- ☐ Reads a 5-line vowelled story with fewer than 3 stumbles
- ☐ Reads a 10-line vowelled story aloud to someone else

Writing

- ☐ Writes right to left without the sticker
- ☐ Writes all 7 families in 4 positions on ruled lines
- ☐ Lifts the pencil after the 6 non-connectors
- ☐ Writes bodies first, then dots, then vowels
- ☐ Copies 4 words a day with all vowels
- ☐ Takes a 3-word dictation with at most 1 error
- ☐ Writes tanween fath with its alif
- ☐ Writes shadda words correctly (no doubled letter written)
- ☐ Writes ال words (including silent-ل sun words with the ل still written)
- ☐ Chooses ة vs ه and ى vs ي at word ends
- ☐ Writes a dictated sentence
- ☐ Writes 3 sentences of her own

Words I can spell (dictation, first try)

Write them in as she gets them. Aim: 5 a week.

Week	Words
1	

Week	Words
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	
9	
10	
11	
12	

Books I can read

Date	Book / page	Alone or with help

If she's stuck on...

- **Joining (Week 1-2):** Do only family pages and magnet-building for a week. Reading joined words is 90% "spot the body." Play "Find the body" (AB #2) on real books.
- **Long vowels:** it's the ear. Clap games with no text for three days, then back to the page.
- **Sukoon:** check madd first; if she's stretching everything, sukoon can't land. Then "glue-it robot" daily.
- **Tanween fath alif:** dictation with "alif police" for a week.
- **Sun letters:** highlighter game. Then chant the moon sentence; everything else is sun.
- **Writing direction:** don't fight it in the reading block; fix it only in the writing block, calmly, every time. It resolves by itself around 8.
- **Speed:** rereading. Three days on the same page always works. A page she can read fast is worth more than two she can read slowly.
- **Motivation:** shorter sessions, a visible chart, and teaching Ayah. Never skip the story at the end; that is the part she'll remember loving.